

Will the grass come back at Ta' Qali?

Government and opposition claims, tested with satellite images

THE CLAIM

“The natural grass grows at a much faster rate well before the rainfall of the winter season.”

Public Works Ministry statement, September 2025, as reported by MaltaToday

PM, Jan 2026: “after the concerts are done, the intervention will happen.”

PN and Momentum: the gravel is choking the grass and could leave the area barren.

VERDICT

CONTRADICTED

*The grass did not return;
the gravel is still there.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

0.53–0.67

Green every winter before

Winter greenness (NDVI) of the picnic area 2023–2025, close to the rest of the park (0.65–0.68).

0.15

Bare in winter 2025–26

After the gravel, the area stayed brown while the rest of the park greened (0.68).

Summer

The dust problem was real

The area was already bare every summer before the gravel, as the park management said.

27 Sep

No intervention visible

Latest clear image (27 September 2026): gravel still in place, area still bare.

2.8 ha

Gravel zone found in the images

About a quarter larger than the 2.2 ha Momentum's inspection reported; edges approximate.

FAIR TO SAY

Whether the damage is permanent cannot be seen from space: it depends on whether the gravel is removed. Intent and procurement are not assessed.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ The consultant's report and dates.

☐ The specification of the material.

☐ Momentum's inspection report in full.

☐ The 2026 events calendar.